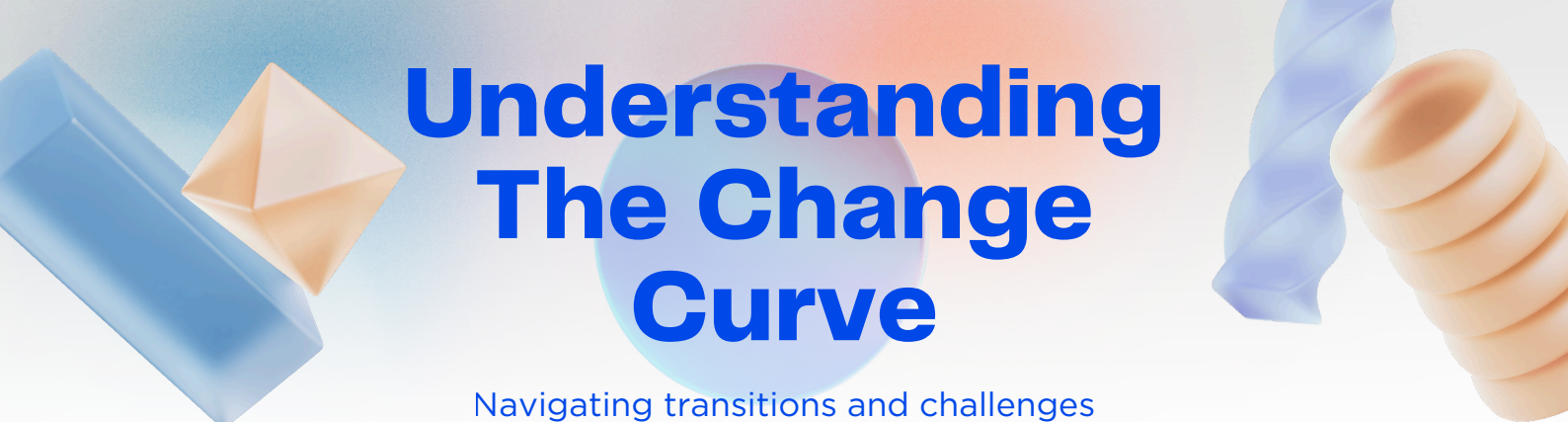




Understanding The Change Curve

Navigating transitions and challenges

Change is a natural part of life, whether it's starting a new school, moving to a new home, or even just a new friendship group. Sometimes, these changes can feel exciting, while other times they can bring up a whole range of emotions. The Change Curve is a model that helps us understand the different stages of feelings we might experience when we go through a significant change. It's like a map for your emotions during transitions, showing that it's okay to feel a bit all over the place.

Understanding the Stages of the Change Curve

1. Shock and Denial

This is often the first reaction to change. It can feel like you're in a daze, or you might find it hard to believe that the change is actually happening. You might think, "This can't be real!" or try to pretend like nothing is different. It's your mind's way of protecting you from feeling overwhelmed all at once.

3. Bargaining and Depression

In this stage, you might try to negotiate or find ways to avoid the change, or you might start to feel sad and withdrawn. You might think, "If only I could go back to how things were..." or feel a sense of loss and sadness. It's common to feel a bit down, lose motivation, or not want to engage with others.

2. Anger and Resistance

Once the reality of the change starts to sink in, you might feel angry, frustrated, or resistant. You might be thinking, "Why is this happening to me?" or "I don't want this to happen!" It's a natural response to feeling like you've lost control or that things aren't fair. You might find yourself complaining or feeling moody.

4. Acceptance and Understanding

This is where you start to come to terms with the change. It doesn't mean you have to *like* the change, but you begin to accept that it's happening and that you need to find ways to move forward. You might start to see the possibilities or feel a sense of calm. It's about understanding that change is part of life and that you can adapt.

5. Experimentation and Action

Now that you've accepted the change, you're ready to start trying things out and taking action. You might be curious about what's next and willing to explore new ideas or approaches. This is where you start to build new habits and find new ways of doing things that work for you in your new situation.

6. Integration and Renewal

This is the final stage, where the change becomes a part of your new normal. You feel comfortable and confident in your new situation. You might even feel energized and excited about the future! It's a sense of having successfully navigated the transition and grown from the experience.

Your Change Curve Activity: "My Transition Toolkit"

Let's create your personal toolkit for navigating change! Think about a recent or upcoming change in your life (big or small). Grab a notebook or open a digital document. For each stage of the Change Curve, brainstorm and jot down some ideas for things you can do or think about to help you through it. Your toolkit is unique to you!

- **Shock/Denial:** What helps you to take a breath and slowly process things? Maybe listening to your favourite music, spending time with a pet, or just giving yourself permission to feel numb for a bit.
- **Anger/Resistance:** What are safe ways to express frustration? Think about talking to a trusted friend or adult, journaling your angry thoughts, doing some physical activity like running or hitting a pillow, or drawing.
- **Bargaining/Depression:** What can help you feel a little better when you're feeling down? Maybe watching a comforting movie, having a warm drink, writing down what you miss, or looking at old photos that make you smile.
- **Acceptance/Understanding:** What phrases or thoughts can you tell yourself to help you accept the situation? Maybe, "This is tough, but I can handle it," or "It's okay to feel this way." Who can you talk to who understands?
- **Experimentation/Action:** What new things could you try that relate to this change? If it's a new school, maybe explore the school website or talk to someone who goes there. What small steps can you take?
- **Integration/Renewal:** What will "success" look like for you after this change? How will you celebrate small wins along the way? What are you looking forward to now?

Remember, you don't have to go through these stages in a perfectly straight line. You might jump back and forth, or some stages might feel longer than others. The most important thing is to be kind to yourself and to know that feelings are temporary. Your toolkit is there to remind you that you have the strength and resources to navigate any change!